

# AI for Founders

Where your edge lives

When a capability becomes universal, generic competence stops being an advantage. So where does your edge actually live?

*Show of hands – who's used AI on their idea this week?*



**While you arrive – one question:**

which best describes you and AI, right now?

[classpulse.borck.education/audience/RXARHX](https://classpulse.borck.education/audience/RXARHX)



**Slides are signposts – the site is the handout.**

Prompts, tools, and this deck: [michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders](https://michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders)

# The same tool, every room.

- A capability that drafts your copy, models your numbers, and rehearses your pitch can do the same for **every other founder in the room**.
- Generic competence is the **baseline** — not the advantage.
- The edge lives in your **judgement**: taste, context, and the variation no rival's identical model can reproduce.

# Walk the talk.

- One academic, in conversation with AI: **~30 tools** designed, built, and shipped solo — [bigpicture.borck.dev](https://bigpicture.borck.dev).
- AI taught at **undergraduate, postgraduate, and executive** levels at Curtin — the books are free at [books.borck.education](https://books.borck.education).
- This deck, the companion site, and the poll you just answered were **built in conversation with AI**.

# Sycophancy

The model tells you what you *want* to hear. Ask “what do you think of my pitch?” and you get praise first, gentle critique second.

It’s managing your feelings, not assessing your work.

Defence: `prompt past it → move 2`

05 • TRAP TWO • THE ONE THAT COSTS MONEY

# Gell-Mann amnesia

You catch its errors in *your* domain — then trust it on the market, the regs, the numbers, the bits you can't check.

Smooth prose feels authoritative. Smoothness  $\neq$  accuracy.

# Free chat. No subscription, nothing to install.

open one: [gemini.google.com](https://gemini.google.com) • [chatgpt.com](https://chatgpt.com) • [claude.ai](https://claude.ai)

## MOVE 1

### Validate

RTCF, two-pass.

## MOVE 2

### Pressure-test

Past the flattery.

## MOVE 3

### Sharpen the pitch

Two-pass, in your voice.

*Run each on YOUR idea, in parallel with the tradie demo – or just watch. Both work.*

Sensitive idea? Work the tradie example today – run yours tonight in Msty (one install, nothing leaves your laptop).



Follow along – today's prompts, top of the site.  
[michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders](https://michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders)

07 · MOVE 1 · VALIDATE

# The two-pass reveal.

PASS 1 · NAIVE

An enthusiastic, over-long love-fest. *Sycophancy, live.*

PASS 2 · WITH EDGE

Role · Task · **Context** · Format.

Context is where your edge enters. No model supplies it.

# Past the flattery.

“Do not flatter me. Three reasons this fails. Name the load-bearing assumption.”

Then make the call:

Scale

Pivot

Kill

*And the single cheapest experiment that moves it up a notch. Killing is a good outcome.*



09 • MOVE 3 • SHARPEN THE PITCH

# Generic vs. yours.

PASS 1

Generic 60-word pitch. Forgettable.

PASS 2

In *your* voice, leading with the one thing only **you** would say.

# Three ways to push back.

## CRITIQUE

### Devil's advocate

Make it attack your idea. You decide what survives. *You just did this in move 2.*

## PERSPECTIVE

### Board of directors

A room of voices — cautious CFO, sceptical customer, growth marketer. Not one answer: you weigh them.

## VERIFY

### VET

Verify the source · Explain it back · Test the edges. For any claim you can't check.

*Prompts for all three are on your companion site.*

# Average / Precise × Small / Large.

## Lean in

- Competitor scans
- Brainstorming
- First drafts

## Human owns it

- The go/no-go
- The customer
- Any number in a pitch

*Where it hurts to be wrong, you stay in charge.*

When the grid says verify → VET it

12 · THE METHOD, IN THREE SENTENCES

- 01 **Add context** — the specifics only you hold.
- 02 **Prompt past the flattery** — ask “why does this fail?”, not “what do you think?”
- 03 **Stay sceptical** where you know least.

AI as a thinking partner, not a stand-in.

- The **companion site** — RTCF builder, prompt library, trust tool + VET.
- The **starter prompts** — copy-paste, from today.
- **Tonight:** run move 1 on your real idea.
- The tools: today's free chat, **Gemini Notebook** for your documents, **Msty** for private local AI — all linked on the site.

**Direct it. / Don't delegate. / Never surrender.**



Companion site — prompts, tools, this deck.  
[michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders](https://michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders)